National Security Concept of Russian Federation policy objectives as part of this plan. The National Security Concept of the Russian Federation on January 10, 2000, declared that:

> Several states are stepping up efforts to weaken Russia politically, economically, militarily, and other ways. Attempts to ignore Russia's interests when resolving significant international relations issues, including conflict situations, can undermine global security and stability and inhibit the positive changes occurring in international relations.[10]

Putin also realized the importance of the so-called underdeveloped countries and their role in international relations. For this, Putin gave importance to southern world countries, and the near abroad region, by rejecting the one-sided decision-making process in international relations. As Chenoy (2001) observed,

> Russian foreign policymakers rejected theories of imperialism that had been the basis of the Soviet Union foreign policy, shunned contradictions with the West, and jettisoned beliefs on Russia's natural alliance with the Third World…..and a debate between those who advocated “Atlanticism” and those who believed in “Eurasianism” as the basic Concept of Russian foreign policy ensued. (2001: 239)

Putin believed that Russia should also focus on the Eurasian region countries without ignoring the Western countries. Putin started building the Russian economy, which was under severe crisis. Russia established good relations with like-minded nations to improve international trade. For this to materialize, Putin extended his network of allies with many states, including Western ones (Kanet 2010: 209). Therefore, the main objectives of Putin during his initial presidency period were as below:

- To strengthen the Russian Federation's stature on an international level.
- To restore the Russian Federations' status as a global player in world politics.
- To bring back growth and stabilization of the economy and the revival of manufacturing and manage energy resources (Rumer and Wallander 2003).